



Going underground



These underground stems grow at the bottom of ponds.

Arrowhead



Dandelion

This plant's bitter roots are used to treat many illnesses.



Beet

The red juice from beets is used as a natural food coloring.



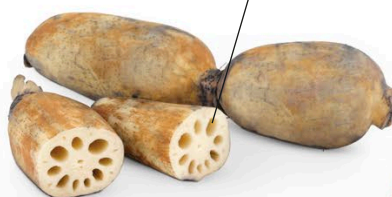
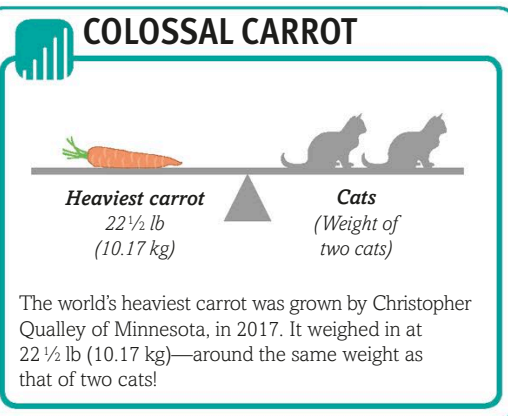
Parsnip

This root becomes sweeter after winter frosts.



Turnip

The white root turns purple when exposed to sunlight.



Air channels form a distinctive pattern.

Lotus root

Vegetables that grow underground can be stored for long periods of time, making them important food crops, especially when other foods are scarce. The swollen roots store energy, which the plants use to regrow in the spring—if they are not eaten first!

Many underground vegetables, including **parsnips**, **beets**, **carrots**, **rutabagas**, and **daikons**, are made of swollen roots, but others store energy in different ways. **Arrowhead** and **taro** plants store energy in bulblike stems called corms, while **lotus roots** are modified stems that grow